

Lower Spanish





About the Course

Alveary Modern Language Lessons are designed to mirror the way children acquire their first language, using methods like gestures, picture recognition, songs, repeated phrases, and storytelling to create meaningful connections and context. These foundational approaches are seamlessly adapted to teach school-age children a second language.

The lessons are designed to be open-and-go with optional video/audio file support. They do not require any background in the target language for the parent/teacher or students. They only take about 15-20 min a day and can be easily adjusted to meet a variety of grade ranges from 1st to 6th grades.

Lower Spanish: Grades 1-6

Video/Audio support is provided for every lesson. We know that learning another language is important to you and we want to provide you with every tool you need to make that happen. Many families and groups may not have access to an experienced native speaker to teach the lessons, so we are bringing the speaker(s) to you! Simply click on the link or scan the QR code for each lesson and follow along in the instructions to teach your child/student even if you have no background knowledge yourself.

Mastery with exposure-based learning takes time. You may not immediately see the results of your labor, but the growth is there. As students learn in this gentle way, they are building a love for a new language. They are beginning to hear the language more easily. And they are gleaning basic vocabulary that they can build on over time. By the end of six years of this exposure-based learning they will be more than ready to start a more serious study of the language with the Alveary's grade 7+ lessons.

There is no "too late" to start these lessons. Even if your child/student only gets one year of Intro Modern Language lessons they will still have started the process of developing a new language. The Alveary's 7+ lessons start at a basic level that can be approached by older students even if they have no previous exposure. So enjoy a year (or more) of the beauty of Modern Language learning without all the added pressure of memorizing and dissecting. There will be plenty of time to master the grammar and basics in the upper grade level lessons, so focus on enjoying instead of stressing over mastering.

PICTURE STUDY

Modern Language picture study lessons aim to build vocabulary exposure and understanding of a new language using

- Gestures/Pointing (TPR)
- Picture Recognition
- Context Building Narration Phrases
- Question/Answer Conversation Practice

Students will learn vocabulary they can use to talk about a picture and engage in a structured question/answer conversation about the picture using a combination of TPR, Total Physical Response, and pictorial vocabulary cards.

EXTENSION DAY (4th+)

- Additional gestures/pointing (TPR) and picture recognition
- Additional question/answer conversation practice with natural exposure to verb conjugation and more speaking/reciting opportunities.

LITERATURE

Modern Language Literature lessons aim to provide context for new vocabulary using

- Comprehension & context building through storytelling
- Some gesture/pointing (TPR)
- Drawing storyboards to aid in retention

to naturally teach grammar through immersion, engage learners emotionally, improve comprehension, and offer a more engaging way to learn compared to traditional methods. This allows better retention of new language elements due to the natural connections made within a narrative.

EXTENSION DAY (4th+)

- Writing (copywork) in the target language
- Practice reading/reciting through storylines

SONGS, RHYMES, & CONVERSATIONS

Modern Language Songs, Rhymes, and Conversations make language learning more engaging and natural by

- Reinforcing vocabulary and pronunciation through rhythm and repetition
- Building confidence
- Improve listening and speaking skills

creating a fun, stress-free environment for mastering new words in context.



Placement & Combining Tips

Three lessons each week are shared between Grades 1-6, but students in Grades 4-6 add two additional extension day lessons. This course is on a six-year rotation of lessons, so it is suitable for students who took Lower Spanish last year or students just starting their studies.

Students in grades 4+ who feel anxious about speaking a new language may benefit from taking a year without the added extension days. This approach allows them to build confidence and comfort before focusing on speaking and writing.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1-6	Lower Spanish: Grades 1-6 3 times/week 20 min 5 times/week 20 min	Spanish: Student Notebook Fábulas de Esopo: Edición Clásica Family Pictures/Cuadros de familia Diez Deditos and Other Play Rhymes and Action Songs from Latin America Diez Deditos (Audio mp3)

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Lower Spanish: Grades 1-6				
Lower Spanish: Grades 1-6	Lower Spanish: Grades 1-6	Lower Spanish: Grades 1-6	Lower Spanish: Grades 1-6	Lower Spanish: Grades 1-6



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Lower Spanish: Grades 1-6



Spanish: Student Notebook



Fábulas de Esopo: Edición Clásica



Family Pictures/Cuadros de familia



Diez Deditos and Other Play Rhymes and Action Songs from Latin America



Diez Deditos (Audio mp3)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Lower Spanish: Grades 1-6

How To Teach



Introduction to Picture Study

Students will complete 1 picture study lesson per week. Students will spend two weeks with the same lesson and vocabulary. Each lesson has an accompanying video to follow along with in the first week and audio recordings for review the second week. In these lessons, students will be focused on beginning the skill of narration in another language within the context of discussing a picture from the assigned picture study book. They will use vocabulary and narration series sentences to help them describe what they see. Narration in another language has a progression and understanding that progression will help you to better gauge where your student is in their understanding of the language and how to help them progress to the next stage.

- Recall - This is the first stage of understanding. When given the Spanish word, students should be able to identify the given word or phrase by pointing to part of a picture, selecting a vocabulary card/image, or performing an action or gesture that demonstrates the given word or phrase. In this stage, students should be able to “build” the narration series with their vocabulary cards or perform associated gestures as they hear the narration series read to them.
- Recite - The next stage of understanding occurs when students can be provided a prompt and respond in Spanish. At this stage, students can be asked to say the narration series as they point to the appropriate portion of the picture being studied, or to say the Spanish word for a given vocabulary card/image, or gesture.
- Compose - In this stage of understanding, students are able to use the vocabulary in creative ways. They will be able to compose sentences with vocabulary cards and then say the corresponding Spanish, or notice something in the picture or the world around them, and be able to describe it using Spanish. Often, the first steps in this direction will be broken Spanish and improper grammar. That is ok. Much in the same way that children learn how to use proper tense and grammatical structure in speaking their first language, they will develop that here too, but it should be by the wayside, and not the primary focus.

NOTE: Vocabulary cards and review activities are provided to help students build a working knowledge of the language; however, they should be used with the end goal in mind. We want students to be able to use the language to describe the pictures in the book and the world around them.



Extension Days (4+)

In grades 4-6, students are given the option of an additional extension day for picture study lessons. These extension lessons gently introduce the concept of verb conjugation by asking students questions using additional vocabulary that they can apply to themselves personally. Students will spend two weeks with the same lesson and vocabulary for these days as well. Each lesson has an accompanying video to follow along with in the first week and audio recordings for review the second week.



Flow of a Lesson

Below is what you can expect for the general flow of a lesson:

- Read/watch any preparatory material and look over any student notebook pages to familiarize yourself.
- Choose a few sentences, words, or vocabulary cards to review at the beginning of each lesson.
- Press play on the video/audio link provided in the QR link page.

- Introduce new vocabulary (pause as needed).
- Practice TPR vocabulary.
- Build narration sentences together.
- Work on picture study application of vocabulary and narration sentences.
- Work on question exercises.



Student Notebook

For picture study lessons, students will have a page with reference images of the vocabulary cards. These images are smaller than the vocabulary cards to aid in saving space for multiple students and also provide a visual without the distraction of moving pieces during the students' first exposure. Visual aids for activities and games during review weeks can also be found here. There may be review weeks or activities that do not require a notebook page. Instructions for those activities can be found in the lesson plans.

Lower Spanish: Grades 1-6

How To Teach



Introduction to Literature

Students will complete 1 literature lesson per week. In these lessons, your student will focus on building listening comprehension. When you first learn a new language, it can be hard to hear it and understand it at the same time. Here, students are encouraged to infer the meaning of a phrase or sentence without the pressure of needing to memorize each individual word and its various use cases. As you work with the vocabulary in these sections, remember that the goal is comprehension in context. The literature lessons have more difficult words and sentence structures in order to build students' ability to comprehend the whole. Students will benefit greatly from working with vocabulary cards in more of a sentence structure for these lessons. They can build the story lines with the vocabulary cards as you read and review, but don't worry if they aren't catching EVERY word. Many of the commonly used words may be hard to "see" in vocabulary card form, but with repetition, students will begin to recognize them. That is why we have also included storyline cards. Students can start to "see" parts of the storyline vocabulary as it is repeated in different contexts.



Extension Days (4+)

In grades 4-6, students are given the option of an additional extension day for literature lessons. These extension days give additional time to practice not just comprehending the story, but also saying it aloud and writing it through copywork in the target language to build familiarity with what the language looks like in written form. Each lesson has accompanying video or audio to follow along with.



Flow of a Lesson

Below is what you can expect for the general flow of a lesson:

- Read/watch any preparatory material and look over any student notebook pages to familiarize yourself.
- Choose a few sentences, words, or vocabulary cards to review at the beginning of each lesson.
- Press play on the video/audio link provided in the QR link page.
- Introduce new vocabulary (pause as needed).
- Practice TPR vocabulary.
- Read the story.
- Practice storyline recognition and building.
- Work on storyboards or copywork.



Student Notebook

On the literature pages of the student notebook, you will find images for any new vocabulary for the week and a storyboard box for students to draw their narrations. Copywork lines have also been provided for students to write the story lines on extension days. Copywork extension days are only scheduled for Grades 4-6.

Lower Spanish: Grades 1-6

How To Teach



Introduction to Songs, Rhymes, & Conversations

Students will complete 1 Songs, Rhymes, & Conversations lesson per week. In these lessons, students are exposed to cultural songs and rhymes and also given the opportunity to practice singing or saying the language out loud in a fun and engaging way. Students can often feel self-conscious or silly when trying to speak a new language, and by using songs & rhymes, we can help them overcome that hurdle. This lesson does not have a video. Instead, it gives teachers step-by-step instructions on how to lead the lesson and includes suggested accompanying audio to follow as you learn the song or rhyme. Students will also begin to learn a few conversational phrases they can use in the target language during these lessons. There are accompanying audio and conversation cards to aid in this part of the lesson.



Flow of a Lesson

Below is what you can expect for the general flow of a lesson:

- Read/watch any preparatory material and look over any student notebook pages to familiarize yourself.
- Choose a few sentences, words, or vocabulary cards to review at the beginning of each lesson.
- Open to the current song/rhyme.
- Press play on the video/audio link provided in the QR link page.
- Practice reciting/singing the passage.
- Listen to the audio introduction of new conversation phrases (pause as needed).
- Practice conversation recognition and building.



Student Notebook

All of the songs have been provided at the front of the student notebook in order to aid in your students' ability to find them easily. For the conversational part of the lessons, it is suggested that students work in pairs. If that is not a possibility, then we recommend students use stuffed animals or puppets to practice this piece. There are no images for the conversation cards in the student notebooks. The conversation cards are for the teacher's benefit and for fun with building conversations as students progress in their speaking abilities.